Functions and positions are graphically presented by the use of blocks or circles. Solid lines connecting the various blocks indicate formal authority relationships. Those with the greatest authority are shown at the top of the chart and those with the least at the bottom. Lines of communication are shown by use of dotted lines and represent informal relationships

For example, as shown in Fig 1.1, the catering manager of a growing cafeteria operation may add an assistant manager, thus creating another level in the chain of command. If the distance from the top to bottom is greater, the responsibilities may be redistributed horizontally through departmentalization.

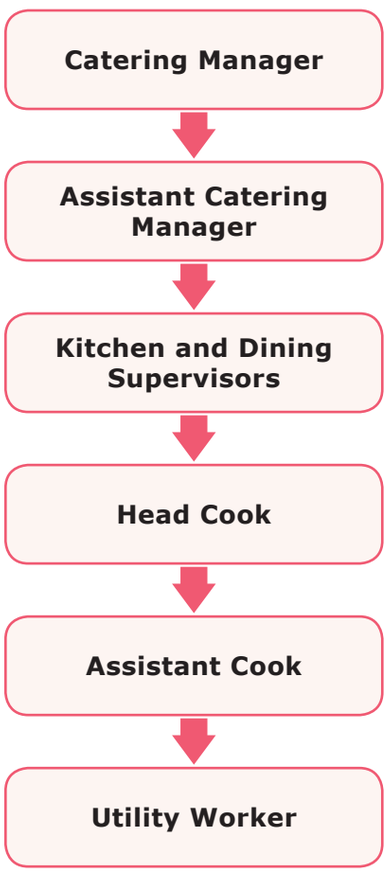


Figure 1.1 Line Organization in Food Service Establishment

b. Line and Staff Organization

As the enterprise grows, it would be difficult for the line organization to cope with many diversified responsibilities assigned by the person at the top. In the line and staff pattern, specialists are positioned at various levels to advice and support those in the line. The manager is positioned at the top and is assisted by the supervisor and specialist cook at the bottom level as depicted in Figure 1.2.

Figure 1.3 depicts the organization chart of a restaurant.

1.3 Organization in Departments

It is important that an organization is divided into departments and sub-departments to assess the staff performance to expected standards. For example, in case of hotels there are front of the house areas (front office) where the employees have direct contact with the guests such as front office and back of the house (back office) areas in which employees have less direct contact with guests such as maintenance, accounting and utility personnel.

The term department means one of the major branches of administration. There are various departments namely front office, food and beverage service, accounts, stores and back office department.

1.3.1 Front office

The front office occupies an important place in the organizational structure of a food service. It is also called the heart of the hotel. It must

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